



BIPOLAR DISORDER: SELF-TESTING

Self-test for bipolar disorder

This self-assessment test comprises three initial questions followed by a checklist. Only if you answer 'yes' to the first three questions should you continue on with the checklist. At the end of the test you will be given your results.

1. Have you had episodes of clinical depression involving a period of at least two weeks where you were significantly depressed and unable to work or only able to work with difficulty – and had at least 4 of the following:
 - Loss of interest and pleasure in most things
 - Appetite or weight change
 - Sleep disturbance
 - Physical slowing or agitation
 - Fatigue or low energy
 - Feeling hopeless and helpless
 - Poor concentration
 - Suicidal thoughts

If **yes**, proceed.

2. Do you have times when your mood 'cycles' i.e. do you experience 'ups' as well as 'downs'?

If **yes**, proceed.

3. During the 'ups' do you feel more 'wired' and 'hyper' than you would experience during times of normal happiness?

If **yes**, proceed.

Please complete the checklist below, rating the extent to which each item applies to you during such 'up' times.

	Much more than usual	Somewhat more than usual	No more than usual
1. Feel more confident and capable			
2. See things in a new and exciting light			
3. Feel very creative with lots of ideas and plans			
4. Become over-involved in new plans & projects			



BIPOLAR DISORDER: SELF-TESTING

Fact Sheet

	Much more than usual	Somewhat more than usual	No more than usual
5. Become totally confident that everything you'll do will succeed			
6. Feel that things are very vivid & crystal clear			
7. Spend, or wish to spend, significant amounts of money			
8. Find that your thoughts race			
9. Notice lots of coincidences occurring			
10. Note that your senses are heightened and your emotions are intensified			
11. Work harder, being much more motivated			
12. Feel one with the world and nature			
13. Believe that things possess a 'special meaning'			
14. Say quite outrageous things			
15. Feel 'high as a kite', elated, ecstatic and 'the best ever'			
16. Feel irritated			
17. Feel quite carefree, not worried about anything			
18. Have much increased interest in sex (whether thoughts and/or actions)			
19. Feel very impatient with people			
20. Laugh more and find lots of things more humorous			
21. Read special significance into things			
22. Talk over people			
23. Have quite mystical experiences			
24. Do fairly outrageous things			
25. Sleep less and not feel tired			
26. Sing			
27. Feel angry			

Scoring

Items are scored as follows:

'2' - Much more than usual

'1' - Somewhat more than usual

'0' - No more than usual

The total score is the sum of all 27 items.

This document may be freely downloaded and distributed on condition no change is made to the content. The information in this document is not intended as a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis or treatment. Not to be used for commercial purposes and not to be hosted electronically outside of the Black Dog Institute website. Updated April 2013.